Theories of Child Personality Development:

Piaget Theory of Cognitive Development

Third Stage
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Growth and Developments

OBJECTIVES

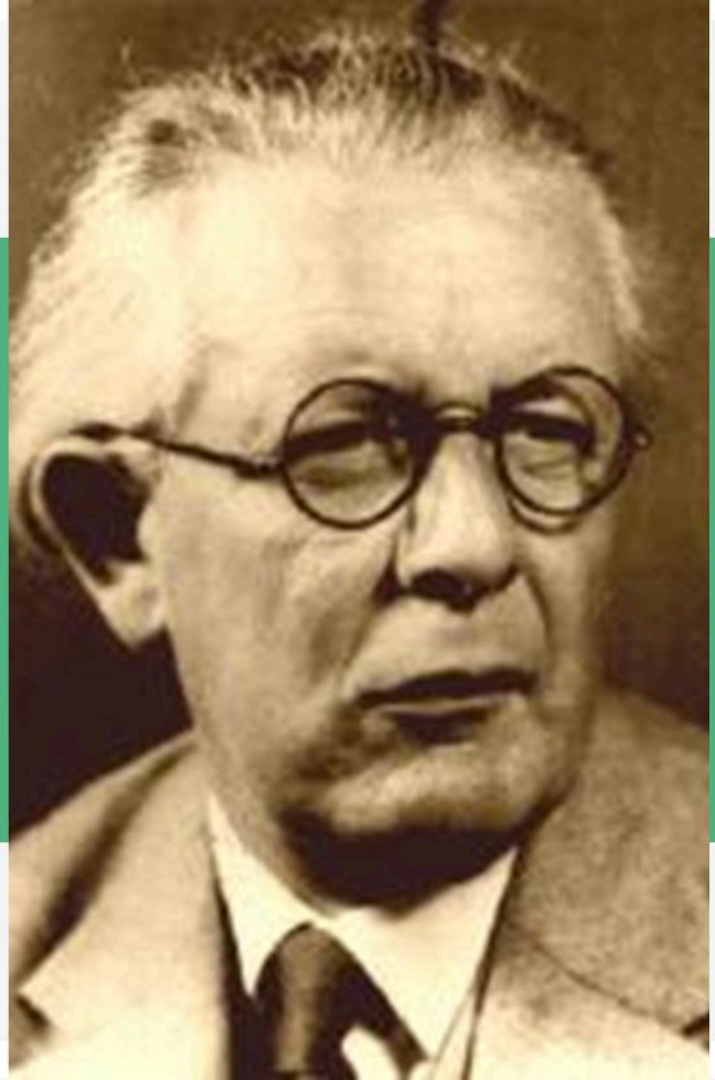


After mastering the contents of this lecture, you should be able to:

1. Identify the major concepts of selected theories of development.
2. Compare the major points of view related to the formulation of selected developmental theories.
3. Assess the relevance of selected theories of development to nursing care of children, adults, and old age.

JEAN PIAGET

Born in (Switzerland) on August 9, 1896.
He died in Geneva on September 16, 1980.



Cognitive development

- Cognitive development represents a progression of mental abilities: Illogical to logical thinking, from simple to complex problem solving, and from understanding concrete ideas to understanding abstract concepts.

Cognitive development

- Piaget believed that cognitive development begins with an inborn ability to adapt to the environment. By rooting for nipple→ exploring the boundaries of the room, young children develop a more accurate picture of their surrounding and greater competence in dealing with them.

The gradual development occurs through three interrelated principles:

1. **Organization**
2. **Adaptation**
3. **Equilibration**

(continued)

The gradual development

1. Organization

- is the tendency to create increasingly complex cognitive structure, systems of knowledge or ways of thinking that incorporate more and more accurate image of reality.
- **(Integration of knowledge into a system to make sense of the environment). These structures, called schemes,** are organized pattern of behavior that a person uses to think in different kinds of situations.

(continued)

The gradual development

1. **Organization**

   - They are cognitive structures that represent a certain aspect of the world, and can be seen as categories which have certain pre-conceived ideas in them.

(continued)

The gradual development

1. Organization

- **For example:**
  - An infant has a simple scheme for sucking but soon develops varied schemes for how to suck at the breast, a bottle, or a thumb.

(continued)

The gradual development

2. Adaptation

- Adjustment to new information about the environment through two steps:

1. **Assimilation**, taking in information and incorporating it into existing cognitive structure.
2. **Accommodation**, changing one's cognitive structures to include the new knowledge.

(continued)

The gradual development

3. Equilibration

- The tendency to strive for equilibrium (balance) among cognitive elements within the organism and between the organism and the outside world.

Phases of Piaget's cognitive developmental theory:

1. **Sensory –Motor Period** (Birth to 2 years).
2. **Preoperational Phase**. 3-5 years old.
3. **Concrete operations**: 7-11 years of age
4. **Formal Operational Period** : 11 - 15/16 years

1. Sensory –Motor Period (Birth to 2 years).

- In this stage infants **explore the world only by senses like touch-putting his fingers in the mouth.**
- The child does not recognize himself as a separate organism.
- Infants **cannot distinguish themselves from their environment.** We can divide this period into several sub-periods.

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1. Sensorimotor stage

* This stage of cognitive development start at birth and lasts up to 2 years of age and is divided into **6 sub-stages**:

1. **Use of reflexes stage (0-1 month).** Characterized by repetition of body movement due to reflexes and the infant is totally autistic (not responding to external stimuli)

1. Sensorimotor stage

2. Primary Circular reactions (1-4 months). Characterized by the following behaviors:

- Recognize familiar faces and objects (e.g. mother and bottle)
- Shows anticipation before feeding
- Discover part of own body through touching
- Awareness of strange surroundings indicates memory
- Becomes bored when left alon
- Accept anybody and no stranger anxiety is observed

3. Secondary Circular Reactions (4-8 months).

Characterized by the following behaviors:

- Search for object that had fallen from him (object permanency)
- Able to tolerate some frustration and delayed gratification
- Imitates sounds and simple gesture
- Actions are deliberate but not goal-directed

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1. Sensorimotor stage

3. Secondary Circular Reactions (4-8 months).

- Great interest in mirror image of himself
- Beginning of independence (self-feeding)
- Language development (few words) which is the beginning of recognition of symbols as type of communication
- Realizes that parents are present even if not in visual field

1. Sensorimotor stage

4. Coordination of secondary Schemata and the Application to new situations (8-12 months).

- Beginning of intellectual reasoning manifested by active searches for a hidden object (**Object Permanence**: Concept that objects still exist when they are out of sight)
- Associate symbols with events by comprehending meanings of words and simple commands and knowing the meaning of gestures (e.g. bye- bye)

(continued)

1. Sensorimotor stage

4. Coordination of secondary Schemata and the Application to new situations (8-12 months).

- Is able to put objects in container
- Works to get toy that is out of reach
- Get away from mother to explore surrounding

1. Sensorimotor stage

5. Tertiary circular reactions. (After 12 months of age up to 18 months)

- Children begin to find a variety of ways of producing an outcome other than the process by which the event has occurred in the child's own past experience.
  1. Experimenting and deliberate manipulation are taken up.
  2. Exploring distance
  3. They try new activities and use trial and error in solving problems
  4. Rituals are important

1. Sensorimotor stage

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1. Sensorimotor stage

6. Mental combinations (Inventions of new means). 18-24 Months.

- Children at this stage can mentally represent events - they no longer confined to trial and error to solve problems
- Symbolic thought allows toddlers to begin to think about events and anticipate their consequences without always resorting to action
- They can begin to demonstrate insight. Can use symbols as gestures and words, and can pretend

2. Preoperational Phase

- Piaget's cognitive theory actually does not include a period specifically for children 3-5 years old.
- The preoperational phase comprises the age span from 2-7 years and is divided into **two stages:**

  1. The preconceptual phase, ages 2-4
  2. The phase of intuitive thought, ages 4-7.

2. Preoperational Phase

- During the preconceptual phase children are **egocentric** (e.g.. Can't take others point of view).
- While during the intuitive phase, there is a shift from totally egocentric thought to **social awareness** and the ability to consider other viewpoints. This transition is very closely associated with the development of **the superego**.

2. Preoperational Phase

- The child is able to think and verbalize his mental processes without having to act out his thinking. However, **he can only think of one idea at a time**, a concept known as centration (inability to think of all parts in terms of the whole).
- Preschoolers judge what they see by the immediate perceptual clues given to them.

2. Preoperational Phase

- **For example**
  - if two lines are equal length are presented in such a way that one appears longer than the other, the child will state that one line is longer, even if he measures the lines with a ruler and finds that each has the same length. The child therefore judges experiences by outside appearance and results, not by intrinsic, logical thinking.

2. Preoperational Phase

- For the nurse to understand that children assimilators in their thinking and with verbal communication she will be able to understand the child.
- For better communication it's important to use "**play**" as a vehicle to understand children of this age group.
- Play becomes the child's work of understanding, adjusting to, and working out his life's experiences.

2. Preoperational Phase

- Because of the child's rich imagination and unlimited ability to invent and imitate, all kinds of play hold therapeutic and communicative value.
- Therefore, to know what a child is really thinking demands skill, time, and patience of those willing to learn to look beyond the words and into the hearts and minds of children.

2. Preoperational Phase

- Preschoolers increasingly use language without comprehending the meaning of words, particularly concepts of **right or left, time,** and **causality.**
- **Superficially causality** resembles logical thought. The child explains a concept as he heard it described by others, but his understanding is limited.
- Their concept of death is, that it is being reversible.

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2. Preoperational Phase

- Nurses must understand that time as a concept is best explained in relationship to an event, such as

" Your mother will visit you after you finish your lunch".

- Avoiding terms such as yesterday, tomorrow, next week, to express when an event is expected to occur and associating time with usual expected daily occurrences help children learn about temporal relationship and increase their trust in others.

- **Children are usually not able to tell about the time in a clock until 7 or 8 years of age.**

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2. Preoperational Phase

- Preschoolers thinking is often described as **magical**. Because of their egocentrism, they believe that thoughts are all-powerful. A typical example is wishing a new sibling dead. If that sibling does die, young children think their wish caused the death.
- Preschoolers believe in the power of words and accept their meaning literally.

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2. Preoperational Phase

- A significant example of this type of thinking is calling the child "bad" because he did something wrong. In the child's mind telling him that he is bad means that he is bad. For this reason it is better to relate such words to the act by saying, for example, "That was a bad thing to do".

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3. Concrete operations: from 7-11 years of age

- Masters the concept of reversibility.
- The concept of **conservation**, or the idea that a mass can be changed in size, shape, volume, or length without losing or adding to the original mass, **is not understood**.
- The child is able to classify things.

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3. Concrete operations: from 7-11 years of age

- **Piaget calls** it concrete operational period, because children in this age are able to deal with concrete **facts logically, but can not think abstractly.**
- Now if you give them the little problem **of the short broad glass and tall thin glass,** they realize immediately that the quantity of the water does not change.

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3. Concrete operations: from 7-11 years of age

- Because children in concrete operation **cannot reason** abstractly they can solve **visual** problems better than verbal problems.
- **Example:**
  - I have three trees in the garden, A, B, & C. A is taller than C but smaller than B. Which tree is the tallest?

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4. Formal Operational Period (11 to 15/16 years)

- Students become able to think abstractly as well as logically.
- They think about their future and parts they will play in society as adults.
- They also think about other people's thinking often critically.
- Consider possibilities, hypotheses.
- Can use **deductive** (general to specific) and **inductive** (specific to general) reasoning.

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Thank you